

**REPUBLIC OF NAURU**  
**NAURU ECONOMIC AND CLIMATE RESILIENCE CITIZENSHIP**  
**(AMENDMENT) BILL 2026**

**SECOND READING SPEECH**

**Honourable Minister Maverick Eoe, MP**

**31 March 2026**

Mr. Speaker Sir,

I introduce to the House today the *Nauru Economic and Climate Resilience Citizenship (Amendment) Bill 2026*.

Mr Speaker and Honourable Members, the proposed amendments in the Bill is intended to improve administrative matters and processes relating to the application for citizenship under the principal Act. Currently the procedure for rejecting an application is the Program Office will receive an application and recommend rejection. The same recommendation is provided to the Registrar who is then required to submit it to the Minister and the Minister to the Cabinet. Once such decision is made, it is conveyed to the Registrar for citizenship which is then conveyed to the Program Office and onward to the applicant. As this is an administrative matter, the Bill seeks to empower the responsible Minister to refuse the grant of citizenship where he or she has received a recommendation to such effect, from the Registrar of Citizenship. This alleviates any delays in the process.

Mr Speaker, Sir, the Bill also amends the definition of ‘Minister’ under *Section 3* to refer to Minister responsible for Nauru Economic and Climate Resilience Citizenship Program Office. This is to be in line with the *Administrative Arrangements Order 2026* and Assignment of responsibilities for Ministerial portfolio.

Mr Speaker and Honourable Members, lastly, the Bill proposes consequential amendments to *Regulation 16* of the *Nauru Economic and Climate Resilience Citizenship Regulations 2024*. The amendment is to supplement the amendment made to *Section 5* of the Act.

Mr Speaker, Sir, the explanatory memorandum summarises the Bill's provisions. Sir, I respectfully request that the accompanying memorandum be read and incorporated into the Hansard Reports.

I commend the Bill to the House.